Commercial Office Vacancy | 2020–2026

Chronological, clickable bibliography • English-language reporting • Prepared October 29, 2026 • U.S. focus

Reading guidance. The evidence documents prolonged high vacancy and reduced demand for conventional office leasing. It does **not** establish that every employer is permanently abandoning offices. Vacancy series are not identical: providers use different market coverage, definitions, and building samples; compare rates **within** a source series rather than treating all published rates as directly interchangeable.

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01 | 2020-07-22 | Reuters

Who still needs the office? U.S. companies start cutting space

Documented relevance: Reuters review of earnings calls found more than 25 large companies planning to shrink office footprints.

Company decisions / early pandemic

02 | 2021-02-26 | Reuters

U.S. urban office market, stung by pandemic, hopes tech firms drive comeback

Documented relevance: Reports that work-from-home trends and changed space requirements could undermine office values and demand.

Demand forecast

03 | 2021-07-06 | WTOP / CBRE

DC office vacancy hits record high, but there are green shoots

Documented relevance: Washington, DC vacancy reached 17.8% in Q2 2021, up four percentage points over the pandemic.

City-level measured vacancy

04 | 2021-08-12 | Los Angeles Times

How remote working is shrinking office space

Documented relevance: Aquent planned to reduce its office space from about 200,000 to 24,000 square feet, closing locations permanently.

Direct company example

05 | 2022-03-29 | Axios

Signs of stress deepen in the office real estate market

Documented relevance: CoStar/Trepp/Barclays-based reporting documents rising vacancies and concerns surrounding office-backed mortgages.

Vacancy / financial stress

06 | 2022-09-25 | Bloomberg

New York City’s Empty Offices Reveal a Global Property Dilemma

Documented relevance: Investigates the impact of hybrid work on older Manhattan buildings and comparable global office markets.

Obsolete office stock / reuse

07 | 2023-02-06 | The News & Observer

Offices sit empty across Triangle as sublease vacancy rates hit record highs

Documented relevance: Reports roughly 3.5 million square feet of sublet space in the Triangle, and overall office vacancy of 13.3%.

Local vacancy / subleases

08 | 2023-04-03 | CoStar News

New York's Office Vacancy Rate Hits Record High as Troubling Signs Stack Up

Documented relevance: Reports Manhattan Q1 2023 vacancy of 16%, citing JLL, amid remote work and economic headwinds.

New York measured vacancy

09 | 2023-04-13 | Axios / CoStar

U.S. office vacancy rate hits all-time high: "Hybrid" work takes toll on landlords

Documented relevance: CoStar series found 12.9% national office vacancy versus 9.4% in Q2 2019; defines broader availability as 16.4%.

Measured vacancy / methodology

10 | 2023-05-09 | Computerworld

After the remote-work rush, vacant offices and empty downtowns

Documented relevance: Reports remote/hybrid work coinciding with reductions in office space use and lease nonrenewals.

Structural demand shift

11 | 2023-11-29 | The Texas Tribune

Texas cities grapple with abundance of empty office space

Documented relevance: Austin, Dallas-Fort Worth and Houston office vacancy rates ranged from 21% to 25%, with shadow vacancy concerns.

Texas / DFW relevance

12 | 2024-01-08 | CNN

Office vacancy rate hits record high

Documented relevance: Moody's Analytics recorded a 19.6% national office vacancy rate in Q4 2023, highest in its series since 1979.

Long-run national vacancy

13 | 2024-01-09 | Axios / Moody's Analytics

Charted: Office vacancies hit a new record high

Documented relevance: Documents shrinking office footprints and sustained remote/hybrid work as vacancy exceeded earlier cyclical peaks.

Data-based structural change

14 | 2024-03-22 | Reuters / Green Street

US office occupancy faces “black hole” of remote work, says Green Street

Documented relevance: Green Street estimated a cumulative 130 million square feet of negative U.S. office net absorption since 2020.

Square-foot demand loss

15 | 2024-04-05 | Quartz / Moody’s

Office vacancies are near 20% as the “slow bleed” continues

Documented relevance: National office vacancy increased to 19.8% in Q1 2024 from 19.6% in the prior quarter.

Measured vacancy

16 | 2024-07-09 | Axios / Moody’s

Office vacancy rate hits record high

Documented relevance: Moody’s reported 20.1% vacancy for Q2 2024 in tracked markets, a record since 1979.

Historical high

17 | 2025-01-10 | Axios / Moody’s

Office vacancies hit a record high despite RTO push

Documented relevance: Moody’s measured 20.4% vacancy in the top 50 metros for 2024; also describes permanent office-demand reduction.

Persistence beyond lockdowns

18 | 2026-04-02 | Axios / Moody’s Analytics

Office vacancies hit record high

Documented relevance: Vacancy reached 21% in Q1 2026 across 79 U.S. markets versus 17% in 2020.

Longitudinal evidence

19 | 2026-06-25 | CBRE Research

Continued Prime Space Recovery Augurs Well for the Rest of the Office Market

Documented relevance: National office vacancy remained near 19%, while prime-office vacancy was much lower at 12.7%.

Critical nuance: quality split

20 | 2026-10-23 | CBRE Research

Q3 2026 U.S. Office Market Report

Documented relevance: CBRE reported 18.2% overall vacancy, the fifth straight quarterly decline, and 11.9% prime-office vacancy.

Current countertrend / recovery

Scope note: This bibliography focuses on office-property vacancy and tenant demand, not an assertion that every category of commercial real estate (industrial, multifamily, retail, hospitality) has followed the same pattern. Articles may require publisher subscriptions.